

Kobe De Maeyer

PHD CANDIDATE IN THE FIELD OF CLIMATE TIPPING
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Professional experience

Utrecht University

Utrecht, The Netherlands

PHD CANDIDATE

2025 - present

- Studying the interaction between two climate tipping elements: the Amazon rainforest and the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation (AMOC).
- Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Ir. Max Rietkerk and Prof. Dr. Ir. Henk Dijkstra. Co-supervisors: Dr. Arie Staal and Dr. Robbin Bastiaansen.
- Hosted by the Copernicus Institute of Sustainable Development in close collaboration with the Institute for Marine and Atmospheric research Utrecht (IMAU) as a part of EMBRACER, a Dutch consortium on Earth system feedbacks.

Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research (PIK)

Potsdam, Germany

STUDENT RESEARCH ASSISTANT

2023 - 2025

- Co-authoring a paper in progress on the evaluation and intercomparison of Global Gridded Crop Models (GGCMs) together with Dr. Cornelia Auer and Dr. Christoph Müller

University of Potsdam

Potsdam, Germany

TUTOR

2023-2024

- Organising weekly tutorials for first-year CLEWS students: “Mathematics and Physics for Earth Sciences” & “Numerical Methods (Programming)”

University of Antwerp

Antwerp, Belgium

OPEN COURSE DEVELOPER

2022

- Adapting and structuring existing course material on statistics into an open course format using Quarto Books

Green Office for KU Leuven

Leuven, Belgium

GREEN OFFICE LIVING LAB COORDINATOR

2021-2022

- Advancing sustainability and transdisciplinarity in university education
- Organising workshops and brainstorming, coordinating an international group of volunteers, connecting thesis students to NPOs, facilitating exchange between thesis students from different disciplines.

Education

University of Potsdam

Potsdam, Germany

M.Sc. IN CLIMATE, EARTH, WATER AND SUSTAINABILITY (CLEWS)

2022-present

- Interdisciplinary program led by the Institute of Environmental Science and Geography, and the Institute of Physics and Astronomy in collaboration with The Potsdam Institute for Climate Impact Research (PIK), the Alfred Wegener Institute for Polar and Marine Research (AWI), and the Helmholtz Centre for Environmental Research (UFZ).
- Thesis titled “Detect, Cluster, Aggregate: methods to study tipping in vegetation model output” at PIK under the supervision of Dr. Sina Loriani and Prof. Dr. Ricarda Winkelmann

KU Leuven

Leuven, Belgium

B.Sc. IN GEOGRAPHY. - MAGNA CUM LAUDE

2019-2022

- Minor (30 CPs) in additional Mathematics and Physics
- Thesis: Precipitation Extremes in Belgium
- Provided voluntary tutoring for the courses “Spatial Data Analysis” and “Physical Geography”
- Honours program: geomorphology of Vorsdonkbos, Aarschot

Extracurricular experience

University centre for development cooperation (UCOS)

Brussels, Belgium

CAMPAIGN FOR SEXUAL HEALTH AND GENDER EQUALITY (CHANGE) - THE CLIMATE EDITION

2022

- Research trip to Cairo (Egypt) to interview activists, experts and organisations working at the intersection of climate change, gender equality and sexual health.
- Intensive training on gender equality, climate change, SRHR, intercultural competencies and campaigning competencies.
- Design and execution of the campaign, “Climate change as common ground”, based on the input of the research trip and training.

YOUCA

Brussels, Belgium

BOARD MEMBER, VOLUNTEER AND AMBASSADOR

2019-present

- Managing a youth organisation striving for a sustainable and just society worldwide using an annual “Solidarity Action Day” concept.
- Exchange to Guinea for a project about sustainable youth entrepreneurship and empowerment.
- Creating and giving workshops and presentations for groups up to 250 youngsters.

Globelink

BOARD MEMBER AND VOLUNTEER

- Managing a youth organisation focused on education and action on global sustainability topics and youth participation.
- Erasmus+ youth exchange in Spain about peer-to-peer methodologies and in Belgium about gender and identity

Brussels, Belgium

2017 - present

Languages

Programming

- R, Python, Julia, (R)markdown, quarto, Latex

Human

- Dutch (mother tongue), English (advanced: C1, TOEFL results of 107 on 07/2022), French (upper intermediate: B2), German (lower intermediate: B1)